rayen-reel-editor · what you need

This is the Claude Code skill that edited the reel: cuts on word boundaries, karaoke captions (Arabic/Derja + English, right-to-left done right), text cards, generated sound effects, a ducked music bed, previews, final render. You talk, Claude edits. The full step-by-step guide with the copy-paste prompts and the feedback rounds comes separately. This page only lists the tools.

1. Accounts

What	Why	Cost
Claude Code (claude.com/code)	the agent that runs the edit	paid plan or API credits; the free plan has no Claude Code
ElevenLabs API key with Speech to Text	every word gets an exact time, the cuts depend on it	free tier for short tests, paid for longer recordings; each recording is transcribed once and cached

Your video never leaves your computer. Only the audio track goes to ElevenLabs.

2. Software

Tool	Needed for	Install
ffmpeg + ffprobe, with libass	cutting, captions, render	Ubuntu/WSL2: `sudo apt install -y ffmpeg` · macOS: `brew install ffmpeg`
Python 3.10+ with numpy, Pillow, requests	the skill's scripts	`pip install -r requirements.txt` (inside the skill folder)
Node.js 22+ (optional)	motion graphics, split screens, background removal, counters: everything HyperFrames does	nodejs.org, or `brew install node`; the skill runs it with `npx hyperframes`

Windows: use WSL2 (Ubuntu) and follow the Ubuntu lines. The skill is not tested in PowerShell.

3. Install the skill (3 minutes)

Easy way: let Claude Code install it. Open a terminal in the folder where the ZIP landed (usually Downloads), start `claude`, paste this and press Enter:

> **PROMPT · PASTE INTO CLAUDE CODE**
>
> Install the Claude Code skill from rayen-reel-editor.zip in this folder (if it is not here, ask me where I saved it). Unzip it into ~/.claude/skills/ so that ~/.claude/skills/rayen-reel-editor/SKILL.md exists. In that folder create a Python venv named .venv and install requirements.txt into it. Make sure ffmpeg and ffprobe are installed, if not install them (sudo apt install -y ffmpeg on Ubuntu/WSL2, brew install ffmpeg on macOS). Copy .env.example to .env, ask me for my ElevenLabs API key and write it after ELEVENLABS_API_KEY= without printing it back. Then run .venv/bin/python scripts/check_setup.py --ping and fix every FAIL it reports until the output ends with READY. Node.js is optional, skip it unless I ask. Finally tell me in three lines what you installed and how I start my first edit.

Claude unzips, installs, asks for your key, runs the check and stops at READY. Have the key ready (elevenlabs.io → Profile → API keys, Speech to Text enabled).

By hand, same result:

```
mkdir -p ~/.claude/skills
unzip rayen-reel-editor.zip -d ~/.claude/skills/    # gives ~/.claude/skills/rayen-reel-editor
cd ~/.claude/skills/rayen-reel-editor
python3 -m venv .venv && .venv/bin/pip install -r requirements.txt
cp .env.example .env                                 # paste your key after ELEVENLABS_API_KEY=
.venv/bin/python scripts/check_setup.py --ping       # must end with READY
```

Then open Claude Code in the folder that holds your recording and say:

> **PROMPT · PASTE INTO CLAUDE CODE**
> Edit my reel: cut the retakes and pauses, karaoke captions in Derja, keep it under 60 s.

Claude proposes a storyboard first and waits for your OK before it cuts anything.

4. What needs what

- Cuts, captions, text cards, sounds, music: ffmpeg + Python only.
- Motion graphics, counters, picture-in-picture, split screen, the "me in a window" reveal, background colour behind you (person matte): Node + HyperFrames (`npx hyperframes`, downloads on first use; the matte model is ~170 MB, CPU is enough, about 1 to 2 frames per second).
- B-roll clips, photos, logos: you provide the files, Claude places them. Credit the owners.

Problems: `scripts/check_setup.py` prints every missing piece. `references/lessons.md` lists the mistakes we already made for you (lip sync, iPhone HDR, Arabic letters, captions under the app UI).

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